Middle Section.—After a short episode (bar 21 to 23) there is a group of entries by inverse movement (bars 24, 26, 28), followed by a return to the subject in its original form and key (bar 30). Then comes an exceptionally long episode (bars 31 to 47), leading back, after various modulations, to the tonic key, in which the subject re-enters in bar 48.

Final Section.—Besides regular entries of the subject in the treble (bar 48), bass (bar 55) and alto (bar 66), there is a further example of inverse movement, (bar 53), the form somewhat varied, and the tonality, that of A, and a final appearance in bar 67 (second half), in the direct form but also somewhat varied.

The episodes in this fugue (bars 6 to 15, 21 to 23, 31 to 47, 49 to 52, 56 to 60, 62 to 65) are extensive and of great importance, occupying no less than 40 bars out of 71. Almost all their thematic material is founded on the subject, except the theme given in the treble of bars 35, 36, which is subsequently combined with the subject in double counterpoint in the twelfth (see bars 48, 49, and 55, 56). Thus, in spite of the large proportion of episode, there is great unity of character throughout, the figure of triplet semiquavers being maintained from the first note of the fugue to the end. Bars 69 to 71 form a short coda.

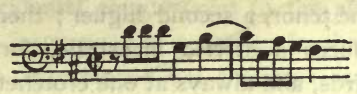
FUGUE 29 (Book II, 5)

D MAJOR (FOUR VOICES).

A fugue remarkable for compactness, the whole of the episodes being formed from the last four notes of the subject.

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 58-60.
BWV 874. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

Exposition.—The subject is given out by the tenor:—



The answer is **real**, and is in the alto. A codetta of one bar—the closing four notes of the subject treated imitatively—leads to the subject in the treble (bar 5) answered by the bass in stretto, (bar 6). There is no regular countersubject; the counterpoints are framed on the four notes already twice alluded to, and exemplify double counterpoint in the tenth (compare bar 3 with bar 6, etc.). The first episode (bars 7 to 10) is in imitation, mostly at one crotchet's distance, and does not effect a modulation, but rather serves as an appendix to the exposition.

Middle Section.—In bars 10 to 13 are two entries (alto and treble), in E minor and B minor respectively, and in bars 14 to 16 the same two voices constitute a two-part stretto in the original key. The second episode (bars 16 to 21) leads to a second stretto (bars 21 to 24), in B minor and F sharp minor, for tenor, treble and alto, at one bar's distance; the answer in the bass (bar 25), which completes this group, is not in stretto. Another three-part stretto follows (bars 27 to 29), the bass, treble and alto (the latter incomplete) giving the subject at distances of one beat, and in the interval of the octave. The third episode (bars 29 to 33) is similar to the first, but somewhat extended. This leads to another three-part stretto, again at one beat's distance, but in ascending sixths, and with the subject complete in each voice. Episode 4 (bars 35 to 40) has much in common with the others, and in modulating back to the key of D, leads to the final section.

Final Section.—An isolated entry of the subject (bars 40, 41) is succeeded by the last and fullest stretto. First the answer in

the bass, slightly modified, is imitated at one bar's distance by a partial entry in the tenor, a second higher; then half a bar later the treble introduces a stretto maestrale, for all the voices, descending by thirds, and always at one crotchet's distance. The coda (bars 47 to 50) is similarly constructed to the episodes.

*Altogether a marvellous little fugue.

FUGUE 30 (Book II, 6)

D MINOR (THREE VOICES).

Exposition.—The subject—



is in the alto; as it reaches the dominant by step progressions and does not modulate, the answer, in the treble, is **real**. A countersubject, mostly in even semiquavers, accompanies it with the exception of its first half bar. The codetta (bar 5) is made from the inversion of the first half bar of the subject, treated imitatively. In bars 6 to 8 the bass takes the subject, the treble the countersubject.

There are few changes of key in this fugue, and it would be possible to regard the first stretti (bars 10 to 12, 14 to 16) as belonging to the opening section, and the middle section as characterised by inverse movement (from bar 17). But the position of the first episode, and the dissimilarity of these stretti to redundant entries or counter-exposition, render it unnatural to include them here. In any case, the division into three sections is not very clear.

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*I cannot refrain from quoting the rest of the Author's characteristic comment in his MS., though it was not intended for publication:—"*Wonderful old fellow, Bach!*" [ED.]